


INVESTOR GUIDE · MUNICIPALITY FACTSHEET AND SUPPORT

# THE MUNICIPALITY IN NUMBERS

Dated and sourced, so you can check.

# CALDAS DA RAINHA IN NUMBERS

**A mid-sized town on the rise: more people, more companies, more homes licensed. Here are the numbers a CFO needs to put Caldas on the shortlist — each with its year and source, so you can check it.**

**+11.6%**
**population 2021→2025**
52,872 → 58,983[1]

**€1.86bn**
**business turnover (2023)**
€130m in goods exports[2]

**1,071**
**homes licensed (2025)**
+30% on 2024[3]

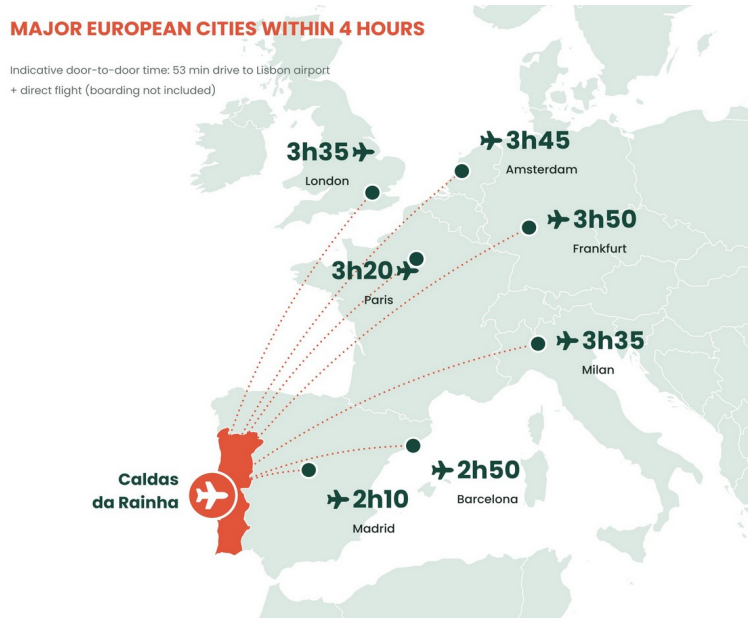
**0.33%**
**municipal surtax (2025)**
with exemptions for job creators[4]

## THE MUNICIPALITY

| INDICATOR | VALUE | YEAR · SOURCE |
|---|---|---|
| **Resident population** | 58,983 | 2025 · Pordata/INE[1] |
| **Density** | 231 per km² | 2025 · Pordata[1] |
| **Residents aged 65+** | 25.0% | 2025 · Pordata[1] |
| **Registered unemployment (15–64)** | ≈3% (1,251 people) | Pordata, latest available year[1] |
| **Non-financial companies** | 8,348 | 2024 · Pordata[1] |
| **Establishments / persons employed** | 8,041 / 21,254 | 2022 · PEDE[5] |
| **Retail (activity 47)** | 883 outlets · 2,838 jobs | 2022 · PEDE[5] |
| **Median bank valuation** | €1,704/m² | 2025 · Pordata (977 €/m² in 2021)[1] |
| **Tourist overnight stays** | 207,225 | 2023 · GEE[2] |
| **Accommodation establishments** | 30 (8 hotels) | 2024 · INE[6] |
| **Municipal budget** | €49.4m | 2026 · Municipality[7] |

*An establishment is not a company, and population growth alone does not prove spending power. For market studies, ask us for parish-level data.*

# CLOSE TO EVERYTHING







| DESTINATION | TIME | HOW |
|---|---|---|
| **Lisbon (Sete Rios)** | ≈56 min | A8, ≈88 km; hourly express coach |
| **Lisbon airport** | ≈53 min | A8, ≈85 km |
| **Leiria** | ≈36 min | A8, ≈55 km |
| **Oeste railway line** | being upgraded | electrification under way; the Government targets 2027 for electric service[8] |

*Indicative route-planner times*[9]

# TALENT AND ECOSYSTEM

- **ESAD.CR** — School of Arts and Design: around 1,600 students and over 130 faculty[10]; named by Domus magazine (2019) among Europe's top 100 design schools.
- **LiDA** — design and arts research lab, rated «Excellent» by FCT[11]. Co-developed with Santos Barosa (Vidrala) a 260 g 75 cl wine bottle under the «Packaging of the Future» agenda (79 partners)[12], winning two Red Dot awards in 2026[13].
- **University of Leiria and Oeste** — established in July 2026[14]; its new Health campus in Caldas opened on 6 October with around 80 students in four higher technical programmes (Thermalism and Wellbeing; Aesthetics, Cosmetics and Wellbeing; Forensic Laboratory; Healthy Eating) and two degrees under accreditation[15].
- **CENCAL · CENFIM** — vocational training for ceramics and glass[16] and for metalworking, with a centre in Caldas[17].
- **UPCaldas** — incubator opened on 12 June 2026: 14 private offices, 20 coworking desks and an auditorium[18]. Over 20 years, AIRO's incubation programme has supported more than 2,000 entrepreneurs and 780 projects[19]; the A8 Innovation Corridor links incubators in Leiria, Caldas, Óbidos and Loures[20].
- **Creative communities** — Prontos and SILOS attract freelancers and small studios who chose to live and work here.

# MUNICIPAL TAXES AND SUPPORT

| INSTRUMENT | WHAT APPLIES | SOURCE |
|---|---|---|
| **Municipal surtax (derrama)** | 0.33% on taxable profit attributable to the municipality (tax year 2025) | [4] |
| **Exemption — small firms** | Prior-year turnover up to €150,000 | [21][22] |
| **Exemption — new firms** | 5 years, with registered office or effective management here and at least 3 jobs created and kept | [21] |
| **Exemption — investment** | 2 years, for investment ≥ €1m with at least 3 jobs | [21] |
| **IMI** | 0.30% (statutory minimum) | [22] |
| **IRS** | 3% returned to residents | [22] |
| **Portugal 2030** | Incentives for innovation, R&D and skills: eligibility depends on the call, activity code, expenditure and timing | [23][24] |

**TIP FOR YOUR BUSINESS CASE**

Exemptions require formal recognition and must meet the regulation's conditions. Send us your activity code, investment breakdown, jobs and start date and we will screen the support options with you.

# LIVING HERE

Parque D. Carlos I steps from the centre, the Óbidos lagoon and Foz do Arelho beach about 15 minutes away, a street market five centuries old, ceramics, jazz and design everywhere. Schools, a hospital centre and a lively cultural scene make Caldas a place where teams want to stay. To prepare your team's move, tell us what you need (housing, schools, healthcare) and we will connect you with the right people.

## LET'S TALK

**Via Expresso · Caldas da Rainha City Council**

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Tell us your activity, space, investment, jobs and timetable. We will walk the rest of the way with you.

## SOURCES

**[1]** Pordata — Caldas da Rainha municipal summary (population 2021–2025, ageing, bank valuations, companies, unemployment) (accessed 9 October 2026) https://www.pordata.pt/en/municipalities/summary+table/caldas+da+rainha-827542

**[2]** GEE / Ministry of Economy — Caldas da Rainha regional statistics (companies, turnover and exports 2023; overnight stays 2023) (2025) https://www.gee.gov.pt/pt/docs/publicacoes/estatisticas-regionais/distritos-concelhos/leiria/caldas-da-rainha/3164-caldas-da-rainha/file

**[3]** Gazeta das Caldas — Record construction in the region (1,071 homes licensed in Caldas in 2025) (23 April 2026) https://gazetadascaldas.pt/economia/nunca-se-construiu-tanto-na-regiao-mas-precos-da-habitacao-continuam-a-disparar/

**[4]** Portuguese Tax Authority — Reported municipal surtax rates, tax year 2025 (Caldas da Rainha 0.33%) (republished 15 July 2026) https://info.portaldasfinancas.gov.pt/pt/informacao_fiscal/legislacao/instrucoes_administrativas/Documents/Oficio-circulado-20293-2026.pdf

**[5]** Municipality of Caldas da Rainha — PEDE, Strategic Economic Development Plan, diagnostic report (retail CAE 47; industrial areas p. 75) (2025)

**[6]** Statistics Portugal (INE) — Caldas da Rainha municipal factsheet (tourist accommodation 2024) (December 2025) https://www.ine.pt/documentos/municipios/1006_2025.pdf

**[7]** Jornal das Caldas — 2026 municipal budget (€49.4m) and SMAS budget; €7–10m wastewater treatment investment dependent on funding (26 December 2025) https://jornaldascaldas.pt/2025/12/26/adiada-para-30-de-dezembro-a-votacao-dos-orcamentos-dos-smas-e-da-camara/

**[8]** ECO — Government announces electrified Oeste railway operation in 2027 (22 September 2025) https://eco.sapo.pt/2025/09/22/governo-promete-entrada-em-funcionamento-da-linha-do-oeste-em-2027/

**[9]** Rome2Rio — Travel times between Caldas da Rainha, Lisbon, Lisbon airport and Leiria (accessed 9 October 2026) https://www.rome2rio.com/s/Lisboa-Sete-Rios/Caldas-da-Rainha

**[10]** ESAD.CR — School profile (approximately 1,600 students, over 130 lecturers) (accessed 9 October 2026) https://www.ipleiria.pt/esadcr-en/school/

**[11]** Polytechnic of Leiria — Research units rated Excellent by FCT, provisional results, including LiDA (15 April 2025) https://www.ipleiria.pt/wp-content/uploads/2025/05/IPLeiria8ui_excelente15_4_25.pdf

**[12]** Observador/Lusa — 260 g wine bottle (LiDA + Santos Barosa), Packaging of the Future agenda, Expo 2025 Osaka (4 August 2025) https://observador.pt/2025/08/04/expo2025-consorcio-portugues-apresenta-garrafa-de-vidro-mais-leve-do-mundo-para-vinho/

**[13]** ECO — University of Leiria and Vidrala win Red Dot 2026 (Packaging Design and Sustainable Design) (8 July 2026) https://eco.sapo.pt/2026/07/08/universidade-de-leiria-e-vidrala-ganham-premio-internacional-com-garrafa-de-paredes-finas/

**[14]** Polytechnic of Leiria — Official Gazette formalises the University of Leiria and Oeste (Decree-Law 135/2026) (9 July 2026) https://www.ipleiria.pt/en/official-gazette-formalizes-the-creation-of-the-university-of-leiria-and-oeste%EF%BF%BC/

**[15]** Observador — ULO opens a health campus in Caldas da Rainha with 80 students and four higher technical programmes (6 October 2026) https://observador.pt/2026/10/06/ulo-abre-polo-de-saude-nas-caldas-da-rainha-com-80-alunos-e-quatro-cursos-tesp-com-licenciaturas-a-caminho/

**[16]** CENCAL — Vocational Training Centre for the Ceramics Industry (accessed 9 October 2026) https://www.cencal.pt/

**[17]** CENFIM — Caldas da Rainha centre (metallurgy and metalworking training) (accessed 8 October 2026) https://www.cenfim.pt/dynamiccontents/show/6.html?company=100069&local_code=69

**[18]** Jornal de Leiria — UPCaldas: opened 12 June 2026, 14 private offices and 20 coworking places (14 June 2026) https://www.jornaldeleiria.pt/index.php/noticia/upcaldas-da-casa-nova-ao-ecossistema-empresarial-do-oeste

**[19]** Diário de Leiria/Lusa — AIRO launches Startup Oeste; 20 years of incubation (2,000+ entrepreneurs, 780+ projects) (3 December 2024) https://www.diarioleiria.pt/2024/12/03/associacao-empresarial-lanca-startup-para-toda-a-regiao-oeste/

**[20]** Gazeta das Caldas — A8 Innovation Corridor connects incubators in Leiria, Caldas, Óbidos and Loures (2025) https://gazetadascaldas.pt/economia/corredor-de-inovacao-a8-une-incubadoras-de-leiria-caldas-da-rainha-obidos-e-loures/

**[21]** Regulation 1095/2023 — Caldas da Rainha municipal surtax relief (Official Gazette, series 2, no. 200) (16 October 2023) https://files.diariodarepublica.pt/2s/2023/10/200000000/0019900201.pdf

**[22]** Jornal das Caldas — Municipal Assembly approves a 3% personal income tax refund and maintains IMI at 0.30%; surtax and exemptions (10 December 2025) https://jornaldascaldas.pt/2025/12/10/assembleia-municipal-aprova-devolucao-de-3-do-irs-e-mantem-imi-nos-030/

**[23]** COMPETE 2030 — Open calls (accessed 8 October 2026) https://compete2030.gov.pt/avisos/

**[24]** IAPMEI — Portugal 2030 incentive schemes (accessed 8 October 2026) https://www.iapmei.pt/pt/saber-mais/incentivos-e-financiamento/sistemas-de-incentivos/portugal-2030/

# Business areas and investment contact

The municipal survey supplied on 19 October 2026 reports approximately 400 ha of industrial land in the current PDM and 586 ha in the proposed revision (+186 ha; approximately +46%). The proposal is subject to approval and these areas are not available plots. See the Asset Map and industrial-area sheets for the breakdown and data limitations.

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